Poem of Gilgameš – Old Babylonian Harmal$_1$: "'Go Up On To The Mountain Crag"

▼ Contents

1a 2
1b 2
2 2
3a 2
3b 3
4 3
5a 4
5b 4
6 4
7 4
8 5
9a 5
9b 5
10 5
11 6
12 6
13 7
14 7
15-16a 7
16b-17a 7
17b 7

- Source: eBL corpus – https://www.ebl.lmu.de/corpus/L/1/4/Old%20Babylonian/Harmal%E2%82%81
- API: https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts/L/1/4/chapters/Old%20Babylonian/Harmal%E2%82%81/display
- Edition: Andrew R. George (editor); Geraldina Rozzi (revision); Enrique Jiménez (revision)
- Translation: Andrew R. George
- Generated by `tools/ebl_fetch.py` on 2026-10-17 – do not edit by hand; re-run the tool instead.

Per line: **N** = normalized Akkadian reconstruction (`|` metrical foot, `||` caesura); **T** = eBL English translation; **L** = lemmas with eBL dictionary glosses; then notes, parallel lines, and the manuscripts' transliterations (ATF). Bibliography keys like [RN117: 889] are resolved in `bibliography.md` (RN117 = George 2003).

1a

- **N:** elī-ma | ana ṣūrim | ša šadî
- **T:** ‘Go up on to the mountain crag,
- **L:** *elī-ma* ← elû III “to go up, arise”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ṣūrim* ← ṣēru I “back, upperside”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *šadî* ← šadû I “st. constr. *šad(i)*”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 250]: “This line is — at least in part — an imperative counterpart of a narrative couplet in OB Schøyen$_2$ 27–8: *īlīma Gilgāmeš ana ṣēr šadîm | ittanaplas kalīšunu ḫursānī*. The meaning of *ṣu$_2$-ri-im* is taken from Semitic cognates, as proposed by [LS304: 217], but the new parallel offers another solution, that *ṣu$_2$-ri-im* is a spelling mistake for *ṣe-ri-im*. The traces after *naplis* were read *a#-na# [eq]-li-im* by [RN2652: 100], but neither copy supports this. Nor does any spelling of *ḫursānī* look possible at the end of the line.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_2$" 27

```
ŠadOB1 o 1a. e#-li#-i-ma a-na ṣu2-ri-im ša# KUR
```

1b

- **N:** naplis | ... [...] ...
- **T:** look at [...] ...’
- **L:** *naplis* ← palāsu I “to look (at)”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_2$" 28

```
ŠadOB1 o 1b. na-ap-li-is3 x [x] x x x x x
```

2

- **N:** šittam | ša ilī || anāku | ekmēku
- **T:** ‘I have been robbed of the sleep of the gods!
- **L:** *šittam* ← šittu I “sleep Bab. good, bad”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ilī* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *anāku* ← anāku I “I”; *ekmēku* ← ekēmu I “to take away, deprive”

```
ŠadOB1 o 2. ši-ta-am ša i-li a-na-ku ek-me2-ku
```

3a

- **N:** ibrī | šuttam | aṭṭul

- **T:** My friend, I saw a dream:
- **L:** *ibrī* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”; *šuttam* ← šuttu I “pl. *šunātu(m)* dream *š. naṭālu*, *amāru* etc. to have a dream, to...”; *aṭṭul* ← naṭālu I “to look”

```
ŠadOB1 o 3a. ib#-ri šu-tam a-ṭu₂-ul
```

3b

- **N:** kī laptat | kī nemiat | kī dalhat
- **T:** how ominous it was, how *desolate*, how confused!
- **L:** *kī* ← kī I “like”; *laptat* ← lapātu I “to touch, take hold of”; *kī* ← kī I “like”; *nemiat* ← nemû I “~ to be strange, disturbing? OB(lit.)”; *kī* ← kī I “like”; *dalhat* ← dalāhu I “to disturb, stir up Bab., OA, NA”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 250]: “The emendation of the second verb follows von Soden. The word *ne-ma-at* defies obvious interpretation as it stands. Alongside the etymology put forward by von Soden (*apû*, ‘to become dim’), one thinks also of *nawiʾat*, ‘it was a desolation’ (on *naw/mûm* see the commentary on *nu-ma-at* in OB III 108).”

```
ŠadOB1 o 3b. ki la-<ap?>-ta#-at# ki ne-ma-at# ki# da#-al#-ha-at
```

4

- **N:** anāku | rīmī (|) ṣērim | aṣṣabtānim
- **T:** I had taken hold of (some) bulls from the wild —
- **L:** *anāku* ← anāku I “I”; *rīmī* ← rīmu I “wild bull hunted”; *ṣērim* ← ṣēru I “back, upperside”; *aṣṣabtānim* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 250]: “The remarkable plural ventive ending on the singular *aṣṣabtānim* elicited from von Soden another OB example, *ki ta-da-am-mi-qu₂-nim* in the poem often called ‘Man and his God’ ([nougayrol1952version: 246], re-edited by [RN1657: 192, 57], who translates ‘that you are well favoured’). Von Soden’s hope that a larger number of examples would eventually elucidate the usage has not yet been fulfilled. T. Jacobsen put forward an ingenious explanation in his discussion of the ‘ablative accusative’, analysing *-nim* instead as ‘departive’ *-n-* and ‘the expected, but hitherto missing, first singular common dative pronominal suffix *-im*, “for me”’ ([jacobsen1963akkadian: 26]). It remains a virtuoso position, unsubstantiated by further enquiry, though B. R. Foster also views the ending as expressing the first-person reflexive ([RN163: 41, fn. 42]: ‘I captured for myself’). Tournay and Shaffer’s emendation to first-person pl. *niṣṣabtānim* ([RN580: 109, fn. 11]) does not make parsing the suffix any easier. In our present state of knowledge these are desperate remedies and it seems wise to resort to neither of them. Thus I ignore the ending and keep to von Soden’s ‘ich packte gerade’.”

```
ŠadOB1 o 4. a-na#-ku AM-MEŠ# ṣe₂#-ri-im aṣ-ṣa-ab-ta-nim
```

5a

- **N:** iš-šasêšu | qaqqaram | ilette
- **T:** (one) was cleaving the ground with its bellowing,
- **L:** *iš-šasêšu* ← ina I, šasû I "(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on"; *qaqqaram* ← qaqqaru I "pl. m. & f. ground, earth"; *ilette* ← letû I "split, divided jB lex. of wood, reed"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 250]: "Though elsewhere in this tablet the scribe writes *ina* and *ana* in full — at least, as transliterated here — the spelling *i-ša-se-šu* very probably represents a pronunciation *iš-šasêšu*."

```
ŠadOB1 o 5a. i-ša-se-šu qa-qa-ra-am i-le-te
```

5b

- **N:** tarbuʾtašu | ittakkip | šamê
- **T:** the cloud of dust it made was thrusting into the sky —
- **L:** *tarbuʾtašu* ← tarbu'u I "dust (storm) Bab."; *ittakkip* ← nakāpu I "to push, thrust Bab., NA"; *šamê* ← šamû I "mostly pl. tant. sky, heaven"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 250]: "Lambert's copy disposes of the problematical *i-na tu-ur šamê* (von Soden; van Dijk read *i-x-x-ip?*). I assume the verb is *nakāpum* I/2 separative, in the present tense to match *ilette*. Alternatively one might read *itakkip* < *takāpum*, 'tinging the sky with colour' (W. G. Lambert, personal communication)."

```
ŠadOB1 o 5b-6. tar-bu-uʾ-ta-šu | ($___$) i-ta#-ki#-ip ša-me-e x
```

6

- **N:** ina pānīšu | anāku | altūd
- **T:** in front of it I leaned myself forward.
- **L:** *ina* ← ina I "(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on"; *pānīšu* ← pānu I "front, pl. face"; *anāku* ← anāku I "I"; *altūd* ← lâdu I "to bend down O/jB, NA"

```
ŠadOB1 o 7. i-na pa-ni-šu a-na-ku?# al?#-tu#-ud
```

7

- **N:** iṣabbat | … […] … | lawiat | ahīya
- **T:** It was seizing … […] was enclosing my arms.
- **L:** *iṣabbat* ← ṣabātu I "to seize, take"; *lawiat* ← lawû II "to surround"; *ahīya* ← ahu II "arm, side (st. constr. *ah(i)*)"

```
ŠadOB1 o 8. i-ṣa-ba-at na-x [x x x x x-i]a? la-wi-at a-hi-ia
```

8

- **N:** … | išlupa[nni | …] … | ina dunni? | …
- **T:** … he pulled [me] forth […] … by force . . .
- **L:** *išlupa[nni* ← šalāpu I “to pull out, draw, unsheathe”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on”; *dunni?* ← dunnu I

```
ŠadOB1 o 9. x-ia iš-lu#-pa-a[n-ni x x x] x-im i-na du?-ni (x) ki# x
```

9a

- **N:** usukkī | … […] …
- **T:** My cheek … […] my …,
- **L:** *usukkī* ← usukku I “Bab.”
- **Note:** [RN117: 250]: “Attractive though it is, the reading *il-pu-t*[*a-ni*] (van Dijk, loc. cit.; von Soden, *AHw*, p. 1439) does not appear compatible with the traces in either of the published copies.”

```
ŠadOB1 o 10a. u₂#-su#-ki il-li#/tu#-x [x x] x-ti-ia
```

9b

- **N:** mê | nādīšu | [išq]ianni
- **T:** [he gave] me water to drink from his waterskin.’
- **L:** *mê* ← mû I “pl. tant. water *mê kabrūtim* mass of water”; *nādīšu* ← nādu I “f.”; *[išq]ianni* ← šaqû III “to give to drink, irrigate”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Boǧ₂" 18'

```
ŠadOB1 o 10b. me-e na-di-šu [iš-q]i₂-a-ni
```

10

- **N:** [il]um | ibrī | ša nellakūšum
- **T:** ‘My friend, the [god] to whom we are going,
- **L:** *[il]um* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *ibrī* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *nellakūšum* ← alāku I “to go”
- **Note:** As noted by [RN117: 247], here and passim verbs I-ʾ are written with a *ne-* sign in the manuscripts from Tell Harmal.
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen₂" 14; cf. L I.4 OB "Boǧ₂" 21'-22'

```
ŠadOB1 r 1. [i-l]um ib-ri ša ne#-la-ku-°šum\°-šum
```

11

- **N:** ul | rīmum-ma || nukkur | mimma
- **T:** is he not the wild bull? He is something strange!
- **L:** *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *rīmum-ma* ← rīmu I “wild bull hunted”; *nukkur* ← nakāru I “to be(come) different”; *mimma* ← mimma I “and sim. anything, something”
- **Note:** [RN117: 251]: “That the first clause is a question is made clear by the new parallel, OB Schøyen$_2$ 15: *ul šadûm-mā nukkur mimma*. In the matter of the last word I follow van Dijk, *Sumer* 14, p. 115, who in *TIM* IX, p. xi, vigorously rejects the reading *mi-im-m*[*u-šu*] proposed by [LS304: 216]. The latter restoration is ruled out for the following reasons: (a) the break appears to be too small to accept both *mu* and *šu*; (b) in order to align the ends of lines with the right-hand edge the scribe of this tablet routinely leaves a big gap before the last sign, but never before the last but one: thus only one sign is expected after *mi-im*; and (c) the parallels have *mimma*, OB Schøyen$_2$ 15 // 17 and MB Boğ$_2$ obv. 23': *ul ḫursān | mimma nuk*[*kur*], the latter already noted by [RN2652: 116]. Landsberger’s translation of the present line, ‘nicht im mindesten ist der Wildstier widrig’, assumes an unusual word order in which the subject (*rīmumma*) splits the predicate (*ul nukkur*). Like von Soden I divide the present line into two clauses, with a caesura at their common boundary: *úl | rīmúmma || núkkur | mímma*.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_2$" 15; cf. L I.4 OB "Boğ$_2$" 21'c-22'a; cf. L I.4 OB "Boğ$_2$" 23'a

```
ŠadOB1 r 2. u₂-ul ri-mu-um-ma# nu-ku-ur mi-im-ma#
```

12

- **N:** zīmū | ša tāmuru || šamaš | namrum
- **T:** The countenance that you saw was shining Šamaš,
- **L:** *zīmū* ← zīmu I “face, appearance Bab., NA mostly pl.”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *tāmuru* ← amāru I “to see”; *šamaš* ← Šamaš I; *namrum* ← nawru I “bright, shining of celestial bodies, as divine epith.”
- **Note:** [RN117: 251]: “Van Dijk and von Soden suggested a reading of the first word as *ri#-mu*. The traces recorded on Lambert’s copy do not concur and I have adopted the reading proposed by J. Renger ([RN168CaRe: 96]). Now that the pattern of the dreams is more clearly understood, Renger’s objection to *ri-mu*, that in this tablet *rīmum* should be written with mimation, is reinforced by the consideration that the wild bull certainly symbolizes Ḫuwawa not Šamaš. Šamaš was well known for his *zīmu*, which was proverbially bright; the word became a technical term for the light emitted by the sun and other celestial bodies (see *CAD* Z, p. 121, and note Renger’s translation ‘Lichtgestalt’). This and the following line find a parallel in a couplet of Enkidu’s explanation of the avalanche dream (OB Schøyen$_2$ 21–2): *u ša tāmuru Šamaš šarru | ina ūmi ša dannatim iṣabbat qātka*.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Nippur" a+6'; cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_2$" 21; cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_3$" b+7'; cf. L I.4 MB "Boğ$_2$" 26'

```
ŠadOB1 r 3. zi#-mu# ša ta-mu-ru {d}UTU na-am-ru-um#
```

13

- **N:** ina dannātim | iṣabbat | qātni
- **T:** he will take our hand in adversity.
- **L:** *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *dannātim* ← dannatu I “”; *iṣabbat* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *qātni* ← qātu I “f.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_{2}$" 22

```
ŠadOB1 r 4. i#-na da-an-na-tim i-ṣa-ba-at qa-at-ni
```

14

- **N:** ša mê | nādīšu | išqûka
- **T:** The one who gave you water to drink from his waterskin
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *mê* ← mû I “pl. tant. water *mê kabrūtim* mass of water”; *nādīšu* ← nādu I “f.”; *išqûka* ← šaqû III “to give to drink, irrigate”

```
ŠadOB1 r 5. ša me-e na-di-šu iš-qu2-ka
```

15-16a

- **N:** ilka | mukabbit (||) qaqqadīka | lugalbanda
- **T:** was your god who honours you, Lugalbanda.
- **L:** *ilka* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *mukabbit* ← kabātu I “to be(come) heavy”; *qaqqadīka* ← qaqqadu I “pl. f. head”; *lugalbanda* ← Lugalbanda I

```
ŠadOB1 r 5-6a. DINGIR-ka mu#-ka-bi-it qa-qa-di-ka | {d}lugal-ban3-da
```

16b-17a

- **N:** nennemmid-ma | ištiat | neppeš
- **T:** We shall join forces and do a thing unique,
- **L:** *nennemmid-ma* ← emēdu I “to lean on”; *ištiat* ← ištēn I “f. *išteat*, *ištiat*, *iš/ltē/īt(um)*, *iš/ltât*, NA *issēt*”; *neppeš* ← epēšu II “to do”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Schøyen$_{2}$" 17

```
ŠadOB1 r 6b-7a. ne-[i]n-ne-mi-id-ma | iš-ti-a-at ne-pe2-iš
```

17b

- **N:** šipram | ša lā ibaššû | in[a] <mā>tim

- **T:** a feat that does not (yet) exist in the land!′
- **L:** *šipram* ← šipru I “pl. *šiprū*, Mari also *šiprānu*”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *ibaššû* ← bašû I “to be (at hand, available)”; *in[a]* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *<mā>tim* ← mātu I “f. land, country”
- **Note:** [RN117: 251]: “On the penultimate sign see van Dijk, *TIM* IX, p. xi: ‘MA or MU impossible, hardly NA, most likely BE or NU, but NA is not excluded’. The emendations given here are confirmed by the appearance of the same line in the Yale tablet (OB III 17): *šipram ša lā ibaššû ina mātim*; cf. already [RN2652: 116, fn. 68]. The lack of *plene* marking of the final *-û* in this tablet may alternatively be explained as signifying a running together of *ibaššû* and *ina* (Lambert). Note the comparable spelling *iṭ-hu-a-na* (OB Schøyen$_2$ 26) for *iṭḫû ana*.”
- **Parallels:** L I.4 OB "III" 17

```
ŠadOB1 r 7b. ši-ip-r[a]-am ša la i-ba-aš-šu-<u₂> i-n[a] <ma>-tim
```